

1. Purpose

To provide recommendations on preventing tenant lockout and provide guidance on how to regain access to a tenant when locked out.

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3. Reference

3.1. Issue

It is the end user's right to, and TD SYNEX supports, restricting TD SYNEX's and reseller access to their tenant and subscriptions. The end user accepts the limitations and potential issues caused by restricting access.

Should a customer become completely locked out, including the reseller and TD SYNEX, the only option to regain access is for the end user's global administrator to contact the Microsoft Data Protection Team directly. Per Microsoft's rules, the reseller and TD SYNEX are not able to assist in the case.

3.2. Lockout Support – TD SYNEX has no Access

The customer will need to contact the Microsoft hotline by using the local number and the support team there will create a Service Request ticket for them.

Microsoft 365/Entra ID Data Protection Team:

If you're part of the company's tenant, find the support phone number for your region at [Get support - Microsoft 365 admin](#). Ask for a ticket to be routed to the Microsoft Data Protection team.

The Data Protection Team does not accept direct inbound calls. They do not have a direct email address. You cannot be transferred directly to them by front line support. Access is only provided by a support case routed to them.

Other Support sites:

[Contact Microsoft Office Support - Microsoft Support](#)

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[Contact Microsoft Azure Support - Microsoft Support](#)

They may also attempt to contact Microsoft Global Customer Service at:

US	1 (800) 642 7676
Canada	1 (877) 568 2495

The process to regain access can take an extended period of time. It is not unheard of for it to take a month or more. Microsoft has a procedure for regaining access that cannot be circumvented.

TD SYNEX has no ability to escalate the ticket. The Microsoft Data Protection Team will not interact with TD SYNEX or our Microsoft contacts.

3.3. Lockout Support – TD SYNEX has Access

TD SYNEX support can open a support case with Microsoft in the end user tenant. To expedite routing, use the following:

Subject: Complete Entra ID tenant lockout. No Global Admins. No Privileged Role Admins

Body: Please route to the Data Protection team

The process to regain access can take an extended period of time. It is not unheard of for it to take a month or more. Microsoft has a procedure for regaining access that cannot be circumvented.

After the ticket is routed to the Microsoft Data Protection team TD SYNEX has no ability to escalate the ticket. The Microsoft Data Protection Team will not interact with TD SYNEX or our Microsoft contacts.

3.4. Prepare for the Data Protection Team

The Microsoft Data Protection Team will request formal verification before restoring access. Some items requested in the past included:

- Tenant ID
- Verified domain DNS access, where applicable.
- Billing or subscription details
- Business registration documents, where applicable
- Authorized signatory confirmation
- A letter from a verifiable C-Level leader via US Mail or Canada Post.

3.5. Recommendations

- Create and maintain an [Emergency Access Account](#) per Microsoft's recommendations
 - Ensure the emergency access account is excluded from all conditional access policies;
 - Test the emergency access account at least annually; and,

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- Ensure that the appropriate parties have access to the emergency access credentials.
- Limit the number of global administrators with access to the tenant; however, have more than one. Microsoft recommends up to five.
- Plan for disruptions when creating new conditional access policies.
 - In addition to the emergency access account, temporarily exclude the creator while testing. Don't forget to remove the creator's exclusion when done;
 - Set to report only mode during testing; and,
 - Test in InPrivate sessions to avoid cached credentials.
- Limit the number of conditional access policies. The more complex the configuration the more likely a lockout will occur.
- Create one policy and test before adding another policy.

4. Associated Documents

- [Contact Microsoft Office Support - Microsoft Support](#)
- [Contact Microsoft Azure Support - Microsoft Support](#)
- [Get support - Microsoft 365 admin | Microsoft Learn](#)
- [Azure Support Options | Microsoft Azure](#)
- [Troubleshoot sign-in issues - Partner Center | Microsoft Learn](#)
- [Preventing Tenant Lockouts - Partner Center | Microsoft Learn](#)
- [Manage emergency access admin accounts - Microsoft Entra ID | Microsoft Learn](#)
- [Best practices to secure with Microsoft Entra ID - Microsoft Entra | Microsoft Learn](#)
- [How can a global admin regain access after accidental lockout? - Microsoft Q&A](#)
- [Locked out of AzureAD as only global admin - Microsoft Q&A](#)
- Tech Note – Emergency Access Accounts | TD SYNEX
- Tech Note – Contacting Microsoft Support | TD SYNEX

5. Document Approval

This document has been approved by:

- Manager, Cloud Sales Engineering

6. Document Revision History

Number	Effective Date	Revision History	Author
1.0	3/6/2024	Initial Draft	David Bloom

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1.1	7/22/2024	Added Data Protection Team phone	David Bloom
1.2	11/6/2025	Added M365 Data Protection Team	David Bloom
2.0	1/12/2026	Updated due to process change	David Bloom